

What Is Existence?

Author: AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org — a group of people studying Madhyasth Darshan philosophy. Source repository: [raghavamohan/AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan](https://github.com/raghavamohan/AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan).

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The question: What is Existence? What exists? Does the thing that exists begin at some time?

This study examines these questions in **Madhyasth Darshan** (Co-existentialism), as presented by **Shri A. Nagraj**, and compares its answers with **Advaita Vedanta** and selected **modern philosophical and scientific approaches** to physical reality, consciousness, and selfhood.

Standpoint and scope

These studies are written from the standpoint of a **scientist and technologist** — someone trained to graduate-level **physics and mathematics**, at home with contemporary cosmology, quantum theory, conservation laws, and the logic of formal models.

From that background, a familiar picture of nature is hard to avoid: **consciousness appears as something the brain does** — an epiphenomenon, functional outcome, or emergent property of particular configurations of very large numbers of physical particles. Modern physics and cognitive science are powerful on mechanism, prediction, and public evidence; yet the hard problem of consciousness, the status of the self, and the reality of value remain fiercely contested. The standpoint taken here does not treat those gaps as settled in favour of matter-only reductionism.

The work begins where that scientific picture leaves open questions — and asks whether Madhyasth Darshan offers a coherent alternative worth examining seriously. This paper reads the primary texts carefully, states what follows from the darshan itself, and compares it in parallel with what we know from **physics and the natural sciences**, **Advaita Vedanta**, and **modern Western philosophy** (especially philosophy of mind). Physics and mathematics are **one leg** of that comparison, not the only one. The aim is rigorous comparative understanding — testing definitions, internal consistency, and fit with public knowledge — not persuasion or devotional endorsement.

These topical studies state the philosophy in clear, checkable prose first. A separate formal mathematical treatment may follow once the definitions and relations are stable across the studies; this paper does not assume or require that treatment.

Quick Glossary

Term	Plain meaning
Existence (<i>astitva</i>)	In Madhyasth Darshan: beingness (<i>hona</i>) and indestructibility (<i>anashita</i>), always present as coexistence (<i>saha-astitva</i>).
Coexistence (<i>saha-astitva</i>)	Reality as the pervasive ground (<i>satta</i>) and all units (<i>ikai</i>) inseparably present together.
Time (<i>kaal</i>)	In Madhyasth Darshan: the duration of unit-activity (<i>kriya</i>), not an independent cosmic container; numerical reckoning of duration is a human convention within existence (§1.8). Full treatment: <i>Nature-Of-Time</i> .
Satta (Omnipresence)	The all-pervasive, formless, non-transforming ground in which all units (<i>ikai</i>) are saturated (<i>samprikt</i>). Translation and naming conventions: Editorial Notes.
Saturation-Reflector Model	Sentience is not generated from dead matter; the ever-present <i>gyan</i> of <i>satta</i> is expressed as active sentience (<i>chaitanya</i>) only when a constitutionally complete atom (<i>gathanpurna parmanu</i>) acts as a stable “reflector.” Full argument: §6.6.
Unit (<i>ikai</i>)	A countable, bounded entity in nature, whether insentient (<i>jada</i>) or sentient (<i>chaitanya</i>).
Jeevan (Sentient Self)	The sentient self: a real, immortal, constitutionally complete unit (<i>gathanpurna parmanu</i>) that works through the body (<i>shareer</i>).
Constitutional Completeness (<i>gathanpurnata</i>)	The first completeness stage: when an atom integrates the required number of particles to become indivisible, immortal, and sentient (<i>jeevan</i>). Threshold of Development Progression, not the final telos of existence (§1.2, §1.6).
Activity Completeness (<i>kriyapurnata</i>)	Restfulness of effort in the sentient atom; the knowledge-order stage of completeness (SB p. 58; MVD pp. 13–14, 27).
Conduct Completeness (<i>vyavaharpurnata</i>)	Destination of motion / authenticity of conduct in the sentient atom (SB p. 58; MVD pp. 13–14, 27).
Six Perspectives (<i>shaad-drishti</i>)	Six evaluative <i>drishti</i> provisioned in <i>jeevan</i> ’s design: lower <i>priya/hita/labh</i> and humane <i>nyaya/dharma/satya</i> (MVD pp. 58, 60, 66–67; §1.5). Full ethics treatment: Ethics-And-Morals-In-Human-Beings .

Term	Plain meaning
Awakening Progression (<i>jagriti-kram</i>)	Activation of higher provisioned <i>drishti</i> toward activity and conduct completeness in the knowledge order; distinct from Development Progression (<i>vikas-kram</i>) in the atom (MVD pp. 13–14, 27, 87; §1.2, §1.5).
<i>Jada</i> / <i>Chaitanya</i>	Insentient and sentient nature (<i>prakriti</i>).
The Four Orders (<i>chaar avastha</i>)	The real, stable developmental plateaus of nature in Madhyasth Darshan: Material (<i>padarth</i>), Pranic/Bio (<i>pran</i>), Animal (<i>jeev</i>), and Knowledge/Human (<i>gyan</i>).
Saturation (<i>samprikt</i>)	Co-location and mutual energetic dependence: every unit soaked, submerged, and surrounded in Omnipresence, energised and regulated through it (§1.2).
<i>Atman</i> / <i>Brahman</i>	Advaita: the Self and the one ultimate reality, finally identical (§2).
<i>Mithya</i>	Advaita: dependent appearance of the empirical world (§2.3).
Sat-Chit-Ananda	Advaita: being, consciousness, bliss as three names of Brahman (§2.2; contrast §5.3).
Physicalism	Modern view: every real concrete phenomenon is physical (§3.1).
Panpsychism	Experientiality belongs, at least primitively, to fundamental reality (§3.3).
Strong / weak emergence	Strong emergence: a higher-level property that is not deducible from, and adds something to, its lower-level base. Weak emergence: a higher-level pattern fully fixed by its base. Relevant to §6.2 and §3.3.

1. The Madhyasth Darshan Answer

To understand existence (*astitva*) in Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism), we must look past two common reductionist tendencies: that matter emerges from consciousness, or that consciousness is merely a byproduct of matter. Instead, the darshan asserts that existence is the eternally present coexistence (*saha-astitva*) of formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and the countless physical (*jada*) and sentient (*chaitanya*) units (*ikai*) held within it. In this view, nothing that exists ever arises from absolute non-existence (*abhava*), nor is it ever annihilated, though units undergo ceaseless motion, transformation, development, and awakening.

To examine this claim, we trace how these units are situated, how they change, how sentience emerges, what *jeevan* is, whether existence begins, and how this ontology contrasts with its

rivals. Cross-tradition answers to the paper's three questions are summarized in §5.2.

1.1 The Coexistential Structure: Space (*Satta*) and Nature (*Prakriti*)

Madhyasth Darshan does not define existence (*astitva*) as an object among objects, nor as a mental category imposed by a knower. It defines existence as the inseparable presentness of formless *satta* and formful nature (*prakriti*) — not matter arising from consciousness, nor consciousness from matter, but the two inseparably present together as coexistence.

SB gives the most compressed formulation:

“What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present. Upon examining their fundamental nature, we learn that all of existence is essentially nature (matter) saturated in Omnipotence (consciousness). Here, ‘seeing’ is intended in the sense of understanding. Since nature saturated in Omnipotence is inseparably present, existence itself is eternally manifest in the form of coexistence.”

- SB, p. 48

The same passage rejects two familiar origin stories:

1. Matter (*jada*) does not arise from *satta*.
2. *Satta* does not arise from matter (*jada*).

Madhyasth Darshan therefore holds that *satta* and units are **co-eternally present** — neither ontologically prior nor posterior to the other. Saturation is not a historical event in which one pole came first and the other followed; it is the ever-present relation in which formless Omnipresence and formful units have always been inseparably together. What changes is not the fact of coexistence but the activity, development, and awakening of units within it (§1.2).

The alternative is not creation of one from the other, but inseparable presentness, expressed in the language of “Realisation Knowledge” (*anubhav jnan*):

“Sentient and insentient nature saturated in Omnipotence. The countless sentient and insentient units are saturated in Omnipotence (Omnipresence).”

- MVD, p. 11

“All units saturated in the Omnipresence (permeative and transparent) have form, properties, essential nature & dharma, and have inherent orderliness & participate in overall orderliness.”

- MVD, p. 11

Existence thus has two inseparable aspects:

1. **Omnipresence (*Satta / Vyapak*):** The formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, immeasurable reality. It is described as actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*): it performs no actions, yet its permeative presence is the ground in which nature is energized, regulated, and conserved.

“Omnipotence is not confined within any dimension of length or breadth, nor can any measure be established for it; therefore, Omnipotence is all-pervasive.”

- SB, p. 49

“Knowledge itself is the omnipresent Omnipotence. This itself is referred to as Space.”

- MVD, p. 35

2. **Units of Nature (*Ikai*):** The formful, active, countable, bounded entities. Units are not illusions in Omnipresence; they have determinate reality and remain surrounded, submerged, and soaked in it.

“Nature, saturated in Omnipotence, exists as countless units. Each unit, being saturated in Omnipotence, remains surrounded, submerged, and soaked in it.”

- SB, p. 48

Naming these two aspects, however, does not yet resolve their ontological relationship. What does it mean, in concrete terms, for a unit to be “saturated” in Omnipresence (*satta*)?

1.2 Saturation: Relation, Development, and Completeness

The source describes units as *samprikt* — soaked, submerged, surrounded — in Omnipresence. This is a vivid image, but an image is not yet an ontological relation; the darshan’s claim of coexistence depends on what this relation is.

Saturation is not constitution: Omnipresence is not the stuff units are made of. Units have their own form, properties, and *dharma* (MVD, p. 11); Omnipresence is formless and non-transforming. If units were made of Omnipresence, their transformation would be transformation of it, which the texts deny. Nor is the relation inherence (*samavaya*) in the Nyaya-Vaisheshika sense, where inherence binds a property to its substance. Omnipresence is not a property the units possess, nor are units properties of Omnipresence; the relation is mutual and symmetric in a way inherence is not. And it cannot be superimposition (*adhyasa*) — the decisive contrast with Advaita. For Advaita, the world’s apparent location “in” Brahman is *adhyasa*, a false attribution later sublated. Madhyasth Darshan explicitly refuses this: units are real and perpetual, never sublated.

The relation that fits the texts is pervasive co-location with mutual energetic dependence. Omnipresence is the omnipresent medium in which every unit is necessarily situated (co-

location), and from which every unit draws the regulatory and conserving energy that keeps it in orderly existence — without Omnipresence acting, transforming, or being consumed. SB states this dependence plainly:

“Every unit in its atomic state is active as orderliness, because it has inherent energy due to being saturated in Omnipotence.”

- SB, p. 69

“Unit + Energy fullness = Activeness.”

- SB, p. 69

The relation is not one-directional. Units depend on *satta* for energy; *satta* depends on units for manifestation as activity. *Satta* remains formless, motionless, and free from pressure, while the whole of nature saturated in it is present with motion and pressure (SB, p. 49). Regulation, activeness, and forcefulness in a unit are seen respectively from its being surrounded, submerged, and soaked in Omnipresence (SB, p. 57). Without unit activity — the source’s term is **basic impulsion** — the energy remains unmanifest; without the energy, there is no basic impulsion (SB, p. 62). This is mutual dependence for manifestation, not mutual constitution: neither is made from the other, neither is cancelled by the other, and *satta* is never an efficient cause — yet its uniform energy does not appear as energisation, regulation, or activity except through the ceaseless activity of saturated units.

Omnipresence is called energy and credited with energizing, regulating, and conserving nature, yet is also called actionless (*kriya-shunya*) and non-transforming. The texts resolve this by distributing the terms: *satta* is actionless in itself, but its energy is manifest as the activity of units through basic impulsion — latent, uniform energy at the root of activity, never acting on its own, yet inseparable from the activity through which alone it is revealed. SB presents mutual dependence as a continuous identity-chain, a characteristic Madhyasth Darshan reasoning pattern ($A = B = C = \dots$):

“Saturation in uniform energy itself is forcefulness, forcefulness itself is basic impulsion, basic impulsion itself is activity, activity itself is effort-motion-result, effort-motion-result itself is development and its continuity.”

- SB, p. 62

Each link is an identity (“itself is”), not an external push. *Satta*’s uniform energy becomes forcefulness only through the unit, becomes activity only through basic impulsion, becomes development only through effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*) — the triad developed in §1.3.

Development within saturation is not directionless. SB states that nature saturated in state-complete Omnipresence is oriented for development and awakening until realization in

Omnipresence, and that each unit embedded in the complete is active and developing **solely for completeness**:

“The nature saturated in the state-complete Omnipotence is oriented for development and awakening until realisation in Omnipotence.

Development refers to constitutional completeness, activity completeness, and conduct completeness, along with their continuity.”

- SB, p. 51

“Each unit, embedded in the complete, is active and developing solely for completeness.”

- SB, p. 51

Madhyasth Darshan names three completeness stages — constitutional (*gathanpurnata*), activity (*kriyapurnata*), and conduct (*vyavaharpurnata*) — with their continuity (SB, pp. 45, 51–52). In the sentient atom, constitutional completeness is immortality of result; activity completeness is restfulness of effort; conduct completeness is destination of motion (SB, p. 58). Constitutional completeness marks the *jeevan* threshold and animal-order hope of living; activity completeness appears in the knowledge order as orderliness with *ness*; conduct completeness as the highest benevolence (SB, pp. 51–52).

Two paths carry this drive and must not be collapsed. **Development Progression** (*vikas-kram*) runs within the atom: an insentient *parmanu* integrates particles until it reaches constitutional completeness and becomes *jeevan* (SB, pp. 58, 80; MVD, p. 76) — traced in §1.6. **Awakening Progression** (*jagriti-kram*) runs in the *jeevan* already constitutionally complete: in humans the milestone of awakening is activity completeness and conduct completeness (MVD, pp. 13–14, 27), with provisioned *drishti* developed in §1.5.

In the first three orders, units do not choose conduct the way deluded humans do. Insentient units lack the thought aspect; their field of activity is limited to length, width, and height (MVD, p. 77). JV states that structural conformity regulates the material order, seed conformity the biological order, and species conformity the animal order — and that every unit of nature except humans exhibits definite conduct (JV, pp. 48, 113). MVD contrasts animal-order *jeevan*, dependent both while performing actions and while experiencing consequences (MVD, p. 69), with humans, for whom knowing and believing — evaluation — are activities of the knowledge order alone (JV, p. 70). The texts never describe completeness as maximisation of a quantity; units move definitely toward fulfilment of their relationships and completeness stages — terminal satisfaction, not unbounded “more.”

How that activity is causally formed — and how *satta* relates to change without being the efficient cause — is §1.3.

1.3 Causation Within Coexistence

Madhyasth Darshan draws a clear line between **origination** (no unit comes from non-being, §1.1) and **causation** (what produces change when units that already exist transform). These

are separate questions; this section answers the second.

The completeness drive (§1.2) does not add a second cause beside units: it names the **direction** in which unit-activity — already structured as effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*) or effort–motion–resolution (*shram–gati–pratishtha*) — runs. This section states **how** that activity is causally formed.

Space (Satta) is not the efficient cause. Omnipresence grounds and conserves all units through saturation (§1.2), but it does not push, act, or initiate change. MVD presents a four-level causal hierarchy before naming *satta* as *mahakaran* (supreme cause):

Gross (sthool) → Subtle (sukshm) → Causal (atma in jeevan) → Supreme cause (vyapak / satta)

1. **Gross (sthool):** bodies or objects constituted of many atoms.
2. **Subtle (sukshm):** atoms themselves.
3. **Causal (karan):** *atma* (within *jeevan*).
4. **Supreme cause (mahakaran):** Omnipresence (*vyapak*).

“An object or body constituted of many atoms is referred to as ‘gross’. Atoms are referred to as ‘subtle’. Atma is referred to as ‘causal’. [Omnipresence] is referred to as ‘supreme cause’.”
- MVD, p. 288

Satta is the supreme cause in the sense of the sustaining ground — not the trigger of any particular transformation (MVD, p. 289; SB, pp. 49, 62). The causal work of change is done by units themselves.

Physical-chemical activity in the material and pranic orders changes through Effort–Motion–Result (*shram–gati–parinam*). This follows a single irreducible triad:

“Every physical-chemical activity is an inseparable presence of effort, motion and result. Each of these is a joint form of the other two.”
- SB, p. 58

Effort, motion, and result are not three sequential steps but three inseparable aspects of the same activity, each implying the other two. Because insentient nature is eternally active, every interaction carries this triad. Two structural patterns follow from it:

- **State and motion are inseparable:** there is force in state, power in motion (SB, pp. 248–249).
- **Give–take complementarity:** after reciprocal exchange, both parties return to their natural state — cyclical restoration, not one-way extraction (SB, pp. 52–53).

Change in the insentient orders is therefore always circular and conserved, never one-way or annihilating.

The sentient self (*jeevan*) changes through Effort–Motion–Resolution (*shram–gati–pratishtha*). Being constitutionally complete (*gathanpurna*), *jeevan* does not undergo physical-chemical transformation. Its activity does not produce a material result (*parinam*). Instead, *jeevan*’s activity culminates in **resolution or establishment (*pratishtha*)** – the cognitive settling of realization and awakened conduct. The progression is: effort in thought (*shram*) → motion in practice (*gati*) → establishment in realization (*pratishtha*).

In the human order, this cycle is additionally *sanskar*-mediated. Insentient units do not unfold knowledge (*gyan udghatan*); only *jeevan* does, through thoughts (MVD, p. 289; §1.7; [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#)). In humans the *shram–gati–pratishtha* cycle is shaped by *sanskar* – **acceptances towards completeness, and knowledge, wisdom and science which gets carried forward towards resolution for evidencing** (MVD, p. 90) – and by the reflection–projection cycle, which can lead either toward awakening or toward decline (MVD, pp. 289–291). Awakening, *sanskar*, environment, study, and humaneness form an explicit circular dependency (MVD, p. 290).

Circular causation is how completeness-directed activity appears in the insentient and sentient orders: not maximisation, but definite movement through the triads named above. Change within coexistence runs through this highly ordered, realist structure of nature – not an amorphous mass.

1.4 The Ontological Orders and Realist Relations of Nature

Nature (*prakriti*) does not exist as an amorphous mass, but as countless physical (*jada*) and sentient (*chaitanya*) units.

“Existence is not just physicochemical matter, but all physical, chemical and jeevan entities are inseparably present in Omnipresence.”

- MVD, p. 5

This is why the human being is understood as a joint form of a physical body (*shareer*) and a sentient self (*jeevan*):

“Brahma (Omnipotence) is omnipresent, and jeevan-clouds are many.”

- MVD, p. 13

“The grandeur of humans as a joint form of jeevan and body.”

- MVD, p. 13

Nature is organized into four real, objective **Ontological Orders** (*chaar avastha*), each defined by its innateness and purpose (*dharma*):

1. **Material Order (*Padarth Avastha*):** Bounded physical and chemical units (atoms, molecules, rocks). Its dharma is bare existence (*astitva / hona*).

2. **Pranic / Bio Order (*Pran Avastha*):** Organic cells, plants, vegetation. Its dharma is growth and biological propagation (*pushti / dharana*).
3. **Animal Order (*Jeev Avastha*):** Animals (body + *jeevan*). Its dharma is the expectation of alive-ness (*jeene ki aasha*).
4. **Knowledge / Human Order (*Gyan Avastha*):** Humans (body + *jeevan*). Its dharma is the expectation of continuous happiness and right-living (*sukh-dharmita*).

These are **objective categories in nature**, not human typologies: material atoms, living cells, animal organisms, and knowledge-order humans each occupy a real plateau whose *dharma* is fixed by the order itself. Each order also cyclically manifests through saturation in *satta*, but in a different mode (MVD, p. 289):

Order	Cyclical manifestation through saturation
Material (<i>padarth</i>)	Units are active because of being in Omnipresence
Bio (<i>pran</i>)	Units have pulsation because of being in it
Animal (<i>jeev</i>)	Units have the hope of living because of being in it
Knowledge / Human (<i>gyan</i>)	Units are hopeful and conscientious because of being in it

Cyclicity is real at every order, but not by one identical mechanism — the general circular structures of §1.3 run through all orders; the table names what distinguishes each order.

For readers approaching from neuroscience, Bhattacharya maps how *jeevan* relates to brain and order (material and biological entities without brain; brain-endowed organisms sometimes without *jeevan*; *jeevan*'s activity mediated through the brain in the knowledge order) — **Bhattacharya**, *The Relationship of Jeevan and Brain*; see also [Why-Humans-Are-Not-Just-Material](#).

These four orders are where development without creation from nothing becomes concrete (§1.6). Each order is a real, stable plateau that the next presupposes, so the upward movement from matter to human is development within coexistence, not the appearance of new substance.

SB p. 49 pairs two infinities in characteristic Madhyasth Darshan parallelism: *satta* is immeasurable by pervasion; *prakriti* is countless by count:

“Omnipotence is not confined within any dimension of length or breadth, nor can any measure be established for it; therefore, Omnipotence is all-pervasive. All the units that exist in the form of nature cannot be counted; therefore, they are countless. In this way, existence itself is omnipresent and countless.”

- SB, p. 49

The orders also carry the paper's ethical claim: because existence is coexistence, units exist in objective relations of complementarity (*poorakata*) and orderliness (*vyavastha*). In the source, the conservation principle follows as a **consequence** of coexistence, not as a standalone axiom:

“Since existence is coexistence, complementarity and mutual recognition are eternally established.”

- SB, p. 49

Relations (*sambandh*) and values (*mulya*) are therefore ontologically real, perpetual structural aspects of coexistence. In the human order, values like trust (*vishvas*), respect (*samman*), and gratitude (*kritagyata*) are the objective recognition and fulfilment of these existential relations. Unlike physicalism (which tends to treat values as brain-model projections) or Advaita (which treats relations as provisional appearances), Madhyasth Darshan grounds ethical value in the actual structure of existence.

Three levels of recognition should be kept apart. **Structural recognition–fulfilment** — complementarity and mutual recognition eternally established (SB, p. 49, quoted above) — belongs to every order. **Constitutional recognition–fulfilment** defines *gathan*: constitution is the process disciplined by the law of recognising and fulfilling among multiple parts (MVD, p. 77). **Evaluative perspective** in the knowledge order uses six provisioned *drishti* — how unawakened humans live in lower perspectives and how awakening activates higher ones — developed in §1.5.

The animal and knowledge orders presuppose a sentient self (*jeevan*) distinct from the body. Its constitution, provisioned perspectives, and awakening progression are the subject of §1.5; how an insentient atom reaches that status through constitutional completeness is §1.6.

1.5 Jeevan: Structure, Perspectives, and Awakening

Jeevan is the sentient self that works through the body (*shareer*) in the animal and knowledge orders (§1.4). MVD calls it a “constitutionally complete atom” (*gathanpurna parmanu*): a structured composite whose completeness consists in the right number of particles integrated into a self-maintaining constitution. Bhattacharya, synthesizing SB, lists five inseparable aspects — *mun*, *vritti*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, and *atma* — within the *jeevan*-cloud (MVD, p. 13). MVD holds that *atma*, *buddhi*, *chitta*, *vritti*, and *mun* are indivisible in a *jeevan*-cloud; energies channel toward development and awakening through them — curiosity, enthusiasm, delight, immersion, and finally realization (MVD, p. 77). The five faculties belong to the same *jeevan*-cloud (MVD, p. 83); every sentient unit is endowed with perspective (MVD, p. 84).

The texts also call *jeevan* indivisible and immortal. Madhyasth Darshan reads “indivisibility” as functional: the constitution is self-maintaining and does not spontaneously lose completeness. “Immortal” means the sentient unit does not lose constitutional completeness — not that it has no parts in a mereological sense.

“Jeevan continues to exist even after death as it does while driving a body.”

- JV, p. 20

Identity across time is continuity of constitution: the same constitutionally complete configuration persists across bodily death and re-association. Death is an event of the body (*shareer*), not of *jeevan* (MVD, p. 13; JV, p. 20).

In the knowledge order, *jeevan*'s design includes more than bodily drive. Madhyasth Darshan holds that six evaluative **perspectives** (*drishti*) are **provisioned in jeevan's constitution** — provisioned in coexistence like the definite structure of development and awakening (MVD, pp. 5, 14–15, 87; JV, p. 59). It is an existential fact, not a cultural overlay. Unawakened humans **operate** through the lower three (*priya, hita, labh* — pleasant/unpleasant, healthy/unhealthy, profit/loss) and the four inhumane propensities (eating, sleeping, defending, mating — MVD, p. 58). Humane (*nyaya, dharma, satya*) and higher-humane perspectives are **present in the design** but become the organizing **refuge** only as **Awakening Progression** advances.

Awakening Progression (§1.2) is explicit in the knowledge order:

“In awakening progression, awakening in deluded humans itself is activity completeness and conduct completeness.”

- MVD, p. 27

“Units of knowledge order have the capacity of understanding. The understanding is about insentient and sentient nature saturated in Omnipotence.”

- MVD, p. 27

“It is natural for humans to have behaviour with other humans, be responsible for glory towards those who are more awakened, and to practise, study & contemplate for their further awakening.”

- MVD, p. 27

The human body is not a neutral vehicle. JV states that human bodies are **provisioned to evidence understanding** — a feature absent in animal bodies — so that *jeevan* can manifest awakening through the union of sentient self and body (JV, p. 59). Capacity is built into existence before any individual achievement.

The six *drishti* form a fixed catalog with domain mapping. MVD classifies the lower three as *amanveeya drishti* (inhumane perspectives):

“Inhumane Perspective (*amanveeya drishti*): - Pleasant-unpleasant, healthy-unhealthy and profit-loss only are the inhumane perspectives.”

- MVD, p. 58

The humane tier (*manveeya drishti*) is justice-injustice, dharma-adharma, and truth-untruth (MVD, p. 60). MVD maps each perspective to what it evaluates:

“The pleasant-unpleasant perspective becomes clear with respect to instincts; healthy-unhealthy perspective becomes clear with respect to the body; profit-loss perspective becomes clear with respect to material goods and comforts; justice-injustice perspective becomes clear with respect to behaviour; dharma-adharma perspective becomes clear with respect to resolution; and truth-untruth perspective becomes clear with respect to realisation in existence.”

- MVD, p. 66

Deluded life defaults to the lower refuge; humane refuge is **necessary** even when not yet lived:

“The behaviour of humans with inhumane perspective is in the refuge of pleasant-unpleasant, healthy-unhealthy, and profit-loss. The behaviour of humans with humane perspective is in the refuge of justice-injustice, dharma-adharma, and truth-untruth.”

- MVD, p. 67

“The necessary behaviour for humans is to adhere to the laws of justice, and the necessary thought for humans is to adhere to the laws of dharma.”

- MVD, p. 67

How higher *drishti* **come online** is spelled out through receptivity (*patrata*). What is provisioned and inherent in coexistence (MVD, pp. 5, 14–15) is not invented by units; it unfolds through study, environment, and means (*sadhan*), as receptivity grows (MVD, pp. 27, 62, 142):

“Study refers to the activity, process, and endeavour performed with remembrance, in the witness of the seat of knowledge (*atma*) and under the light of realisation. The extent of one’s receptivity constitutes one’s qualification; the manner of conduct arising from this qualification is referred to as perspective; and the reflection attained through this perspective is referred to as worldview.”

- MVD, p. 142

When content is available but humane *drishti* is lacking, MVD names the remedial endeavour **grace** (*krupa*) — instilling the receptivity that was provisioned but not yet active (MVD, p. 61).

Every unit saturated in Omnipresence is active and developing solely for completeness (SB, p. 51). In *jeevan* already *gathanpurna*, that drive does not stop at constitutional completeness: it orients Awakening Progression toward activity completeness (*kriyapurnata*) and conduct completeness (*vyavaharpurnata*). Provisioned *drishti* are the evaluative registers through which that orientation becomes lived perspective — lower registers active first, higher registers activating through awakening (*drishti*, *patrata*, refuge [*aashray*]).

Awakening is not binary. MVD describes tiers of development on the knowledge order:

“Humans who have realised the truth and embody thought and behaviour aligned with justice and dharma are awakened or developed. Those who have thought and behaviour aligned with justice & dharma are half-developed. Those who have thought and behaviour aligned with justice are partially developed or progressive. Those who are attached to thoughts and behaviour of injustice are heading towards decline and are in the form of animalistic-human and demonic-human.”

- MVD, p. 160

Subordination, not erasure, governs the relation of lower to higher *drishti*. Heart’s fulfilment leads to health gain; sensory satisfaction does not necessarily lead to heart’s satisfaction (MVD, p. 66). Pleasure, health, and profit are not denied — they are insufficient as the organizing refuge ([Ethics-And-Morals-In-Human-Beings](#) §3.2). The knowledge-order unit **contains** material, bio, and animal activities; evolution is reorganization under higher perspective, not abandonment of body and goods (MVD, p. 52, cited in comparative studies).

Activation is not automatic. Completeness drive meets **means** — environment, study, and contemplation (MVD, p. 27) — and the *darshan-drishya-drishti* structure developed in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#) §1.4 and §1.9 (sensitivity vs comprehension). Behavioural and social expression of the six perspectives belongs in [Human Behavior and Society](#); this section states the ontological design of *jeevan* in the knowledge order.

How an insentient atom reaches constitutional completeness and becomes *jeevan* is §1.6.

Omnipresence as *gyan* and *jeevan* as knower is §1.7.

1.6 Constitutional Completeness and *Jeevan*

While Madhyasth Darshan rejects creation from nothing, it gives a developmental account of how an insentient atom (*parmanu*) reaches *gathanpurnata* — the first completeness stage in Development Progression (§1.2). Constitutional completeness forms the immortal sentient self whose structure and awakening progression are stated in §1.5.

“In the course of an atom’s development, there comes a stage when the required number of particles for its constitution are all integrated, and at that point, it becomes constitutionally complete. Constitutional completeness signifies satisfaction within, by, and for that constitution. This is the immortality of the result, and the attainment of sentient status.”

- SB, p. 59

“All types of atoms, including constitutionally complete ones, are eternally present through the natural law of coexistence in existence.”

- SB, p. 59

SB adds a quantitative-stability criterion for constitutional completeness:

“In this state of completeness, there is neither an increase nor a decrease in the number of particles in the atom. Due to this stability, the constitutionally complete atom possesses inexhaustible power and force. A constitutionally complete atom undergoes qualitative change without any quantitative change.”

- SB, p. 55

In the sentient atom, constitutional completeness appears as immortality of result (SB, p. 58). MVD states that the fundamental unit is the insentient atom, which through development attains sentience as evidence of constitutional completeness; upon achieving it, its endeavour is toward activity completeness (MVD, p. 76). The transition is irreversible: a constitutionally complete atom does not revert to insentience (SB, pp. 55, 59, 92). Constitutional completeness is therefore the ontological threshold at which an atom becomes *jeevan* — sentient, immortal in constitution, and oriented toward further completeness through activity and conduct (§1.2, §1.5).

Omnipresence is called Knowledge (*gyan*) while active knowing belongs to *jeevan*; that two-level structure is developed in §1.7.

1.7 Omnipresence as *Gyan* and *Jeevan* as Knower

The source calls Omnipresence Knowledge (*gyan*) while denying it the activity of knowing (MVD, p. 35; quoted in §1.1).

Gyan here names a condition of intelligibility — reality is such that it can be known, is orderly, transparent, lawful — rather than an act of cognition. Omnipresence is “Knowledge” the way a perfectly legible text is “meaning” even when no one is reading it. The knowing act (*chaitanya*) belongs only to *jeevan* (§1.5).

The texts sharpen this distinction further. MVD p. 289 states explicitly that **the unfolding of knowledge** (*gyan udghatan*) occurs **only** through the sentient aspect (*jeevan*) or

thoughts — not through insentient units and not through Omnipresence acting as a knower. MVD p. 115 adds a narrower formulation: knowledge is inherent everywhere, but **its unfolding happens by awakened humans** — a sleeping, deluded *jeevan* cannot unfold it. The same passage describes a sensory/cognitive pathway: vibrational motion on the brain from the cognitive organs leads to the unfolding of knowledge. *Gyan* as a name of *satta* is the intelligibility-ground; *gyan udghatan* is an activity exclusive to awakened *jeevan*.

Jeevan does not invent the structure of development and awakening. MVD postulates that development and awakening are **definite**, and that all laws are **natural and inherent to being and abiding**:

“The alternative human-centric contemplation, based on the knowledge of existence in the form of coexistence, postulates that existence is stable, the development and awakening are definite, and all the laws are natural and inherent to being and abiding.”

- MVD, p. 5

In the Verity chain, orderliness (*vyavastha*) **is** development and awakening (MVD, p. 15). MVD also provides for the study of development progression and awakening progression as distinct provisions in coexistence (MVD, p. 87; JV, p. 59). Units manifest what is provisioned and inherent through increasing receptivity (*patrata*), study, and environment (MVD, pp. 27, 142) — not by creating the frame from nothing.

Whether existence itself begins presupposes an account of time and conservation.

1.8 Does Existence Begin? Time (*Kaal*) and Conservation

For Madhyasth Darshan, existence does not begin in the sense of coming from absolute non-existence (*abhava*). What exists has always existed, though its form, configuration, and states are in constant flux:

“That which exists continues to be, and that which was not, does not come into existence. Therefore, existence will remain as it is till eternity.”

- SB, p. 49

“Nothing arrives at birth nor does anything depart with death. All that is, exists forever.”

- JV, p. 20

“Jeevan continues to exist even after death as it does while driving a body.”

- JV, p. 20

The texts infer *jeevan*'s post-death survival from the conservation principle: nothing existent is annihilated, and *jeevan* is an immortal sentient unit whose constitutional completeness does not lapse at bodily death (§1.5).

The nature of *kaal* (preview)

Whether what exists begins **at some time** presupposes an account of time. Madhyasth Darshan does not treat time (*kaal*) as an independent cosmic dimension, substance, or container in which existence sits. The primary texts define it through **activity**:

“Time (*kaal*): Duration of an activity is referred to as time.”

- MVD, p. 34 (also p. 196; p. 338: “Duration of activity”)

Time is therefore inseparable from the motion, change, and effort–motion–result cycles of active units (§1.3). Where there is no transforming activity — in formless, actionless Omnipresence (*satta*) — there is no *kaal* in this sense. *Satta* is non-transforming (*kriya-shunya*); coexistence as a whole is beginningless and endless (below), and SB names one of *satta*'s English equivalents **Eternity** (SB, p. 48).

This is not a denial that units undergo real change. Insentient and sentient units are eternally active; development (*vikas*), cyclical restoration, and awakening are temporal processes **within** coexistence, not passages into or out of existence itself. The circular causality of §1.3 is also a temporal structure: effort, motion, and result are inseparable aspects of ongoing activity, not a static snapshot.

Timeless truth and the three times. SB states that the harmony of consciousness and matter is:

“...a timeless truth valid across all three times.”

- SB, p. 48

The Sanskrit *trikaalabadh* (binding across past, present, and future) applies to coexistence as a whole — not to prove that *kaal* is illusory, but that what is understood about coexistence does not come and go with a moment. MVD also describes Omnipresence (*vyapak*) as existing “**at all places and times, and ... eternally present**” (MVD, p. 34). *Satta* is atemporal as ground (formless, non-transforming), yet coexistence is valid across the three times; *kaal* as duration belongs to the activity of units, not to *satta* as efficient cause.

Measurement and numerical reckoning. Duration is real as an aspect of activity, but the **reckoning** of time is conventional within existence:

“Time is measured by the duration of an activity.”

- *SB*, p. 65

“The duration of activity, as time, is a humanly devised numerical reckoning within existence.”

- *SB*, p. 251

“The measurement of time, expanse and different compositions is through mathematics.”

- *MVD*, p. 195

So *kaal* is not a freestanding entity alongside *satta* and *ikai*; it is the duration of unit-activity, made explicit for human purposes through number and mathematics. How past, present, and future relate to “activity eternally present” — a theme developed in JVD (p. 85) — is treated comparatively in *Nature-Of-Time* (§1.5); residual questions remain in that study’s §6. This ontology distinguishes absolute annihilation (*vinasha*) from physical transformation (*roopantaran*). An entity changes configuration, but its underlying substance (*vastu*) is never destroyed:

“A piece of charcoal continues to exist in other forms even after burning it.”

- *JV*, p. 20

“At the fundamental level, a ‘reality’ never gets annihilated.”

- *JV*, p. 20

The result is a conservation-based ontology:

1. Existence (*astitva*) as coexistence (*saha-astitva*) is beginningless and endless.
2. Omnipresence (*satta*) does not begin, change, or end.
3. Units (*ikai*) do not arise from non-being (*abhava*) and do not vanish into it.
4. Particular bodies (*shareer*), configurations, relations, and states do begin and end.
5. Development (*vikas*) and awakening (*jagriti*) are real, but are not creation out of nothing.

Against Advaita and physicalism, Madhyasth Darshan stakes its own ground in the eight Reality propositions and the slogan *jagat satat* (perpetual world).

1.9 The Perpetual World: *Brahma Satya Hai, Jagat Satat Hai*

MVD presents eight co-implicated **Reality** propositions (pp. 12–13). One of them compresses the ontology:

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.”

- MVD, p. 13

The full set gives systematic context — the slogan is not isolated:

1. Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.
2. Brahma (Omnipotence) is omnipresent, and *jeevan*-clouds are many.
3. *Atma*, *buddhi*, *chitta*, *vrutti*, and *mun* are indivisible in a *jeevan*-cloud.
4. The grandeur of humans as a joint form of *jeevan* and body.
5. God is omnipresent, deities are many.
6. Human kind is one, vocations are many.
7. Earth is one (undivided nation), States are many.
8. *Jeevan* is immortal; birth and death are occurrences.

Nagraj's autobiographical account describes the Vedanta formula *Brahma satya, jagat mithya* as part of his intellectual background; Madhyasth Darshan's *jagat satat* (perpetual world) stands in **structural contrast** with that background within the eight Reality propositions.

Madhyasth Darshan thus rejects two reductions that would split this inseparable whole:

1. **Material reductionism:** only physicochemical matter (*jada*) exists.
2. **World-negating spiritualism:** only the formless ground (*satta*) is finally real, and the world is diminished to mere appearance.

Its positive claim: Brahma is real, the world is real, and their inseparable presentness is coexistence (*saha-astitva*).

2. The Advaita Vedanta Answer

Advaita Vedanta provides a contrasting framework to Madhyasth Darshan: it asserts that existence in the strictest, absolute sense is Brahman alone, one without a second. In this view, the world of names, forms, bodies, and relations is *mithya*—a dependent appearance that is operationally valid at the empirical level (*vyavahara*) but ultimately sublated at the level of absolute reality (*paramartha*). The true Self (*Atman*) is neither born nor destroyed, because it is ultimately identical with this non-dual Brahman.

Advaita's standard framework is three-tiered, separating private apparent errors (*pratibhasika*, such as a rope mistaken for a snake) from shared empirical reality (*vyavahara*, which governs bodies, physical laws, ethics, and scripture) and the absolute truth of Brahman (*paramartha*).

2.1 Existence Alone, One Without a Second

“In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second.”

- CU 6.2.1

Shankara glosses *sat* as:

“mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness”

- CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary

The text rejects existence arising from non-existence:

“By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second.”

- CU 6.2.2

2.2 Sat-Chit-Ananda: Being, Consciousness, Bliss

A second classical formulation names existence not only as *sat* — bare being — but as **Sat-Chit-Ananda**: being-consciousness-bliss. These are not three realities added together; Brahman is one partless reality whose nature is expressed in three inseparable names.

“Brahman is Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity.”

- TU 2.1.1

Shankara’s tradition reads *satyam* as being/reality, *jnanam* as consciousness, and *anantam* as the infinite. The *anandamaya* passage (TU 2.5) leads the seeker beyond even bliss-as-sheath to the Self beyond all coverings. Shankara states the mature formula in the *Vivekachudamani*:

“By that alone he comes to know his own Self as Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute and becomes happy.”

- VC, v. 152

The same triad recurs at v. 217, one of the most comprehensive Self-descriptions in the *Vivekachudamani*:

“That which clearly manifests Itself in the states of wakefulness, dream and profound sleep; which is inwardly perceived in the mind in various forms as an unbroken series of egoistic impressions; which witnesses the egoism, the Buddhi, etc., which are of diverse forms and modifications; and which makes Itself felt as the Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute; know thou this Atman, thy own Self, within thy heart.”

- VC, v. 217

The Mandukya Upanishad (MU, vv. 3–7) grounds this analysis in the three states (*avasthaya*): waking, dream, and deep sleep — with **turiya**, the witness beyond all states, as ultimately real. In this scheme:

1. **Sat** — Brahman is existence; to exist absolutely is to be Brahman.
2. **Chit** — consciousness is the very nature of reality and Self, not a function of brain or mind.
3. **Ananda** — bliss is the intrinsic fullness of the Self, free from lack and dependence on objects.

So for Advaita the answer to “what is existence?” is concentrated: existence is the one reality that is being, consciousness, and bliss without a second.

2.3 What Exists in Advaita?

Strict answer: Brahman alone exists absolutely. The world is not sheer nothing, nor absolutely real; it is *mithya*.

“A firm conviction of the mind to the effect that Brahman is real and the universe unreal, is designated as discrimination (Viveka) between the Real and the unreal.”

- VC, v. 20

“The individual soul is itself and directly the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else.”

- VC, v. 216

The clay-pot analogy (a *satkaryavada* illustration; see §5):

“All modifications of clay, such as the jar, which are always accepted by the mind as real, are (in reality) nothing but clay. Similarly, this entire universe which is produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman Itself and nothing but That.”

- VC, v. 251

Level	What exists?	Status of world / error
Apparent (<i>pratibhasika</i>)	Rope-snake, dream objects, private errors	Sublated by waking or correction
Empirical (<i>vyavahara</i>)	Bodies, minds, Ishvara, causes, duties, scriptures, science	Shared, law-governed; operationally valid; sublated only by <i>brahma-jnana</i>
Absolute (<i>paramartha</i>)	Brahman alone	World is <i>mithya</i> , dependent appearance

At *vyavahara*, the world is not unreal in the way a hallucination is; it is unreal **relative to Brahman** — like a dream relative to waking. This distinction matters for comparing Advaita’s ethics and science with Madhyasth Darshan’s perpetual world (§6.3).

2.4 The Structural Entities of Advaita

Because Advaita utilizes a three-tier framework of reality, it posits several “entities” that are structurally necessary to explain the empirical world, even if they are ultimately sublated at the absolute level. These are the specific concepts compared against Madhyasth Darshan in §5:

1. **Brahman / Paramatman:** The sole absolute reality (*paramartha*). It is pure, actionless awareness.
2. **Maya:** The cosmic ontological power — Brahman viewed through *Maya* as Ishvara. It conceals Brahman’s true nature (*avarana*) and projects the multiplicity of the world (*vikshepa*). VC vv. 243–244 distinguish **Maya** (cosmic, Ishvara’s superimposition) from **Avidya** (individual, jiva’s superimposition).
3. **Avidya:** Individual ignorance — the jiva’s superimposition of body-mind on the Self. Distinct from cosmic *Maya* (VC, vv. 243–244).
4. **Ishvara (Saguna Brahman):** Brahman associated with *Maya*, functioning as operative cause of name-form manifestation (*vivartavada*) — not a creator *ex nihilo*. Ishvara is a *vyavahara*-level category:

“These two are the superimpositions of Ishwara and the Jiva respectively, and when these are perfectly eliminated, there is neither Ishwara nor Jiva.”

- VC, v. 244

1. **Jivatman (Jiva):** The individual embodied soul — the true Self (*Atman*) conditioned by *upadhis* (e.g. *Pancha Kosha*), appearing as separate until realization.
2. **Jagat (Nama-Roopa):** The physical universe of names and forms. Operationally valid at *vyavahara*; ultimately *mithya* at *paramartha*.

The *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* (DDV) offers a rigorous seer-seen (*drig-drishya*) discrimination: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is “seen” and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5). What remains is *Sakshin*, witness-consciousness — irreducible to matter and closer to Advaita’s first-person route against physicalism than devotional VC passages alone (see §3.2, §6.3).

2.5 Does What Exists Begin?

Brahman does not begin: it is beginningless, partless, actionless, non-dual. The universe as name-form has origination at the empirical level, but its ultimate truth is Brahman. Creation is therefore not production from nothing; it is manifestation of names and forms on the basis of Brahman (*vivartavada* — apparent transformation, contrasted with Madhyasth Darshan’s circular causality in §5.1).

Liberation (*moksha*) is not dissolution or merger of a real individual into Brahman. The jiva was never a separate entity; realization is **recognition of pre-existing identity** with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled:

“There is neither death nor birth, neither a bound nor a struggling soul, neither a seeker after Liberation nor a liberated one — this is the ultimate truth.”

- VC, v. 574

“The Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless and changeless, devoid of interior or exterior, the One Existence, without a second, and one’s own Self.”

- VC, v. 393

2.6 Time and temporality

Advaita does not devote a separate chapter to *kaal*, but its framework implies a sharp division. **Brahman** is beginningless, changeless, motionless — outside temporal becoming (VC, v. 393). At *paramartha*, only Brahman is absolutely real; temporality belongs to the empirical order. At *vyavahara*, past, present, and future, birth and death, and causal succession are operationally valid — the world is law-governed and shared (§2.3) — yet finally sublated when Brahman alone is known.

The *Mandukya* analysis of waking, dream, and deep sleep (§2.2) is a first-person route into how temporal **states** appear and are witnessed; the witness (*turiya*) is not another state among them. Madhyasth Darshan accepts the reality of cyclical development and unit-activity across orders (§1.3–1.4) and refuses to sublimate the world at the highest realization; its account of *kaal* as duration of activity (§1.8) is therefore closer to a **realist** temporal ontology at every order, while still denying that time is a substance independent of activity. Comparison with Advaita’s *trikaal* language and with Madhyasth Darshan’s *trikaalabaddh* coexistence claim (SB, p. 48) is developed in *Nature-Of-Time* (§2.2, §4).

3. Modern Philosophical Approaches

If Advaita Vedanta represents a radical anti-materialism that subordinates the physical world to pure consciousness, modern Western philosophy of mind represents the opposite starting point. It takes the physical world as its baseline and struggles to locate subjective experience within it. The resulting debates on consciousness impose a severe explanatory burden of proof on any entity—such as *jeevan*—that claims to transcend physical mechanics, showing that the definition of what exists remains fiercely contested.

3.1 Standard Physicalism: Concrete Reality Is Physical

“I take physicalism to be the view that every real, concrete phenomenon in the universe is...physical.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 2

On this view, what exists are physical things, events, fields, organisms, brains, and processes. Minds and selves are functions, organizations, models, or processes of physical systems.

3.2 The Hard Problem: Experience Resists Reduction

“The really hard problem of consciousness is the problem of experience. When we think and perceive, there is a whirl of information-processing, but there is also a subjective aspect.”

- Chalmers 1995, p. 3

“It is widely agreed that experience arises from a physical basis, but we have no good explanation of why and how it so arises.”

- Chalmers 1995, p. 3

“the fact that an organism has conscious experience at all means, basically, that there is something it is like to be that organism.”

- Nagel 1974, p. 1

For Madhyasth Darshan this is evidence that body-only ontology is incomplete. Advaita's DDV offers a complementary first-person route: the seer cannot be the seen (DDV, vv. 1–5), so consciousness resists reduction to observed brain-states — though Advaita and Madhyasth Darshan draw different ontological conclusions from that datum. The physicalist reply — that an explanatory gap is not proof of *jeevan* — is the central disagreement, and the paper should grant that an explanatory gap is, indeed, not by itself an existence proof (see §6.2, §6.4).

3.3 Panpsychist Physicalism: Experience as Fundamental

“Full recognition of the reality of experience, then, is the obligatory starting point for any remotely realistic version of physicalism.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 2

“Experiential phenomena cannot be emergent from wholly non-experiential phenomena.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 12

“Real physicalism, realistic physicalism, entails panpsychism.”

- Strawson 2006, p. 12

This is closer to Madhyasth Darshan than reductive physicalism, since both refuse experience-from-dead-matter. But the agreement cuts both ways. Strawson’s anti-emergence principle presses on the *gathanpurnata* account: if experience cannot emerge from the wholly non-experiential, then either the pre-complete atom is not wholly non-experiential (latency reply, §6.6), or the threshold account is a form of the emergence Strawson rejects (§6.2). Madhyasth Darshan also differs from Strawson in scope: it does not say every particle is a subject; sentience is the status of constitutionally complete atoms only. The two views share an enemy (dead-matter reductionism) but not a metaphysic.

3.4 Alternative Ontologies: Process & Neutral Monism

Process philosophy and neutral monism are closer Western analogues than the mainstream philosophy-of-mind sources above.

Whitehead’s process philosophy is arguably the closest analogue: plurality is real, relations are ontologically fundamental, and reality is perpetual becoming rather than static substance. His basic units are “actual entities” — “drops of experience, complex and interdependent” (Whitehead 1929, p. 28) — which resemble units-in-relation, and his refusal to bifurcate nature parallels the refusal of both world-negation and matter-only reductionism. The key contrast: Whitehead’s occasions are momentary and “perpetually perish” subjectively, gaining “objective immortality” only as data for successors (Whitehead 1929, p. 44), whereas Madhyasth Darshan’s *jeevan* is a persisting immortal individual — so the two agree on relational realism but disagree sharply on individual persistence.

“Actual entities ‘perpetually perish’ subjectively, but are immortal objectively.”

- Whitehead 1929, p. 44

Neutral monism (Russell, Mach) resembles the account of Omnipresence as a reality that is neither mind nor matter but the common ground of both. Russell holds that mind and matter are “composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material” (Russell 1921, Lecture I). Mach likewise denies any “rift between the psychical and the

physical”: “There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed” (Mach 1914, Ch. XIV). The contrast: neutral monism typically builds mind and matter out of the neutral stuff, whereas Madhyasth Darshan keeps Omnipresence non-transforming and lets units be real in their own right rather than constructed from the ground.

“Both mind and matter are composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material.”

- Russell 1921, Lecture I

“There is no rift between the psychical and the physical, no inside and outside... There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed.”

- Mach 1914, Ch. XIV

3.5 Illusionism: Phenomenal Consciousness as Misdescription

“Another approach, which holds that phenomenal consciousness is an illusion and aims to explain why it seems to exist.”

- Frankish 2016, p. 1

“illusionists deny the existence of phenomenal consciousness properly so-called, but do not deny the existence of a form of consciousness”

- Frankish 2016, p. 8

Madhyasth Darshan regards this as another reductionism: it treats experience, valuation, aspiration, and realization as activities of *jeevan*, not brain-model illusions. Illusionism matters because it shows how far naturalism will go to preserve a physicalist ontology.

4. Modern Scientific Approaches

While modern science does not put forward a single metaphysical dogma, its default working ontology aligns with §3.1 physicalism unless the hard problem forces a revision (§3.2–3.3). It seeks to explain the self as an emergent product of evolutionary and neurobiological processes, and the universe as a dynamic physical system. Although cosmology and quantum field theory occasionally offer structural resonance with the beginningless, conserved nature of units in Madhyasth Darshan, science generally resists any posits of eternal, non-physical sentience.

4.1 Cognitive Science & Neuroscience: The Brain as Generator of Self

Self-model theories in cognitive science (pioneered philosophically by Metzinger 2003) build upon the physicalist premise. They argue that the self is not an immortal unit, but a

predictive model generated by the brain to regulate the organism:

“minimal selfhood emerges as the result”

- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 1

“these accounts propose to ‘understand the elusive sense of minimal self in terms of having internal models that successfully predict or match the sensory consequences of our own movement, our intentions in action, and our sensory input’.”

- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 3

This is nearly the opposite of the *jeevan* ontology. For Madhyasth Darshan the self is a real sentient unit using the body; for self-model theory the self is a model generated by embodied prediction. One interpretive fork for constitutional completeness — sentience as achievement of a self-maintaining form rather than addition of a new ingredient — moves uncomfortably close to “self as self-maintaining structure”; that fork and its tension with self-model theory are examined in §6.2.

4.2 Physical Cosmology: Does the Physical Universe Begin?

The standard cosmological model suggests the observable universe had a beginning ~13.8 billion years ago. Several non-singular research programs (loop quantum cosmology’s “bounce,” Penrose’s conformal cyclic cosmology, eternal inflation) are comfortable with a beginningless physical substrate even when local configurations begin and end. These are competing speculative programs, not consensus — the most this paper claims is **conceptual resonance** with Madhyasth Darshan’s claim that nature (*prakriti*) is perpetual (*satat*), not proof of it (Ashtekar and Singh 2011; Penrose 2010; Guth 2007).

4.3 Physics & Conservation Laws

The “nothing is annihilated” principle and modern physics — handle with care.

Particle–antiparticle annihilation and pair creation are not passages into or out of absolute non-being: in quantum field theory (see standard treatments, e.g., Weinberg 1995), particles are localized excitations of conserved, all-pervasive fields, and annihilation transforms one excitation (matter) into another (radiation) under strict conservation laws. This is broadly consonant with the claim that fundamental reality (*vastu*) is conserved while configurations (*roop*) transform. But the alignment should not be overstated: fields are not “substances that persist” in quite the sense *vastu* intends, and energy conservation itself is subtle in General Relativity (it is tied, via Noether’s theorem, to time-symmetry that need not hold globally in an expanding spacetime; see Carroll 2010). The right verb is “is consonant with,” not “is supported by.”

Fields vs. *vastu*. In quantum field theory, what persists are field configurations and conserved quantities; a “particle” is a localized excitation, not a tiny enduring substance. Madhyasth Darshan’s *vastu* names an underlying reality that survives every *roop*-change.

The parallel is structural (configuration changes, something is conserved), not identity of category: fields are mathematical-physical entities governed by equations, not countable units with *dharma* saturated in Omnipresence.

Satta and physical fields (misleading analogies). A dynamical field carries energy-momentum, exerts force, and propagates waves — nothing like the actionless (*kriya-shunya*), non-transforming *satta* (§1.2). Comparing *satta* to a physical field is therefore misleading. The nearest physical analogue — non-dynamical background geometry or the quantum vacuum ground state — captures only that units depend on a uniform ground; it drops the darshan's second half: uniform energy stays unmanifest without unit activity (§1.2). The parallel is illustrative, not identity.

Time (*kaal*) vs. spacetime. Modern physics treats spacetime as a dynamical entity — it can expand, curve, and in some models begin locally. Madhyasth Darshan treats *kaal* as the **duration of unit-activity**, numerically reckoned by humans within existence (§1.8; SB, pp. 65, 251; MVD, pp. 34, 195) — not an independent cosmic container. Omnipresence is timeless as non-transforming ground. The contrast is over whether temporality belongs to the ground of reality or only to transforming units, and over whether spacetime is fundamental physics or derivative of measurement conventions on activity. Relational and process philosophies of time (§3.4) share some structural affinity with activity-based *kaal*; block-universe eternalism does not. Comparative detail: [*Nature-Of-Time*](#).

Entropy vs. orderliness (*vyavastha*). Thermodynamics describes a statistical arrow toward disorder in closed systems. Madhyasth Darshan asserts inherent orderliness at every order, with development toward greater organization when units are in their natural state. These are not straightforward opposites — biological and ecological systems can increase local order at the cost of entropy elsewhere — but they use different notions of “order,” and the paper should not treat the second law as evidence for or against coexistence.

Against all of these, Madhyasth Darshan makes a stronger claim: coexistence is eternal, units are not annihilated, and *jeevan* is immortal. This eternalism is consistent with conservation principles and beginningless cosmological models, but its claims about individual immortality and constitutional completeness remain distinct metaphysical assertions not validated by current science.

5. Comparison

The sections below compare entities and causal doctrines across traditions; §6 evaluates each position.

5.0 Entity categories compared

§5.4 tabulates entities; what follows groups them by tradition.

Modern philosophy (§3):

1. **Cosmic Ground:** Neutral stuff (neutral monism) or creativity/becoming (process philosophy).
2. **Individual Self:** Self-model (physicalism) or experiential monads (panpsychism).
3. **Material Reality:** Physical matter and energy; or the outer aspect of experiential units (panpsychism).
4. **Causation:** Efficient mechanism (physicalism) or creative concrescence (process).

Modern science (§4):

1. **Cosmic Ground:** Dynamic spacetime and quantum fields — no inherent consciousness or teleology.
2. **Individual Self:** Brain-generated cognitive agent; no post-death survival.
3. **Material Reality:** Localized field excitations; conserved under physical law.
4. **Causation & Order:** Physical causation, entropy, evolved ecological cooperation.

5.1 Causal doctrine: *Satkaryavada*, *Vivartavada*, and Madhyasth Darshan

Causal doctrine is the deepest structural difference between the three systems — it determines how each answers “does what exists begin?”

Advaita (Sankhya inheritance): *Satkaryavada* — the effect pre-exists in the cause (clay-pot, VC v. 251). At the empirical level, creation is *vivartavada*: apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman — the effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through *Maya*.

Madhyasth Darshan: Denies single-material-cause reduction and linear efficient-cause chains. *Satta* is *mahakaran* (supreme sustaining cause), not efficient cause (§1.3). Units change through dual activity triads — *shram-gati-parinam* (insentient) and *shram-gati-pratishtha* (sentient) — with circular activity, order-specific cyclicity, and *sanskar*-mediated human cycles. Conservation of *vastu* through *roop*-change resembles *parinamavada* at the unit level, but the full picture is not reducible to “*parinamavada*-like” alone.

Modern physicalism: Strict efficient causation — mechanism, fields, conservation laws. Origination of particular systems is compatible with a beginningless substrate (§4.2); no teleology or supreme ground.

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Effect in cause?	Yes (<i>satkaryavada</i>)	Units eternal; change is transformation within coexistence	Conservation laws; particles as field excitations
Cause transforms?	No (Brahman changeless; <i>vivarta</i>)	<i>Satta</i> non-transforming; units transform	Fields/spacetime dynamical

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Origination vs change	Name-form originates at <i>vyavahara</i> ; Brahman does not begin	No origination from <i>abhava</i> ; development and awakening	Local systems begin/end; substrate unsettled

5.2 At-a-glance comparative summary

This table compares the three traditions on the paper's main ontological questions and related themes. Causal doctrine in detail: §5.1.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
What is existence?	Eternally present coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units held in it.	Brahman / Existence alone, one without a second.	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically.
What exists?	Omnipresence and real units, sentient and insentient.	Brahman alone (absolutely); world <i>mithya</i> at <i>paramartha</i> .	Usually the physical; experience disputed.
Does it begin?	No — what exists does not come from non-existence; bodies and configurations do.	Brahman does not begin; name-form at <i>vyavahara</i> .	Particular systems begin and end; cosmology unsettled.
Does the individual self begin?	<i>Jeevan</i> does not begin at birth or die with the body.	<i>Jiva</i> is ultimately Brahman; separate individuality dispelled at realization (VC, vv. 244, 574).	Self develops as biological/cognitive process.
What is time?	Duration of unit-activity; human numerical reckoning within existence; <i>satta</i> timeless as ground (§1.8).	Brahman beyond temporal becoming; time valid at <i>vyavahara</i> , sublated at <i>paramartha</i> .	Spacetime as dynamical physical structure; philosophy of time contested.
Is the world finally real?	Yes. "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."	Empirically valid but ultimately <i>mithya</i> .	Yes, as physical reality.
Method of knowing	Study, realization, behavior, experiment.	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination.	Observation, modelling, public evidence.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches
Ethical consequence	Humane conduct evidences understanding of coexistence.	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation.	Ethics via naturalism, social/normative theory.

5.3 The Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast, distributed

Advaita's Sat-Chit-Ananda and Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence can sound alike — both speak of being, consciousness, and fulfilment. The contrast is over what those words name and whether the world survives them.

For Advaita, *sat*, *chit*, *ananda* are three names for one ultimate reality without a second; the world is finally *mithya*. For Madhyasth Darshan, the same vocabulary is distributed across coexistence, not compressed into one subject:

Concept	Advaita Vedanta (Unified Non-Dualism)	Madhyasth Darshan (Distributed Coexistence)
Sat (Being)	Brahman alone is Sat; the world is a dependent appearance ultimately negated.	Beingness (<i>astitva</i>) is coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless real units.
Chit (Consciousness)	Pure awareness, identical to the inner Self; the world of names/forms is inert.	Omnipresence is pervasive knowledge/condition-of-intelligibility (§1.7), but active sentience (<i>chaitanya</i>) belongs to the <i>jeevan</i> unit.
Ananda (Bliss)	Intrinsic nature of Brahman; sensory joy is a distorted reflection.	Harmony realized within the awakened <i>jeevan</i> , expressed as humane conduct.

Modern philosophy has no parallel formula: it may treat experience as physical, fundamental, or illusory, but it does not name existence as Sat-Chit-Ananda or as coexistence.

5.4 Entity comparison

The table compares primary entities across the four traditions this paper develops in the body. Abrahamic, Buddhist, and Dvaita ontologies are outside scope; they are not included here.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Cosmic Ground	Omnipresence (Satta / Space): Pervasive, formless, actionless energy (<i>kriya-shunya</i>). Units depend on it for energy; its energy manifests as activity only through units (§1.2).	Brahman: The single, non-dual absolute reality (<i>Sat-Chit-Ananda</i>). The world is <i>mithya</i> (dependent appearance) at <i>paramartha</i> .	Creativity / God (Process): Dynamic process. Neutral Stuff (Neutral Monism): Common element.	Spacetime & Quantum Fields: Dynamic, physical substrate. No inherent consciousness or teleology.
Individual Self / Sentience	Jeevan: A constitutionally complete, immortal atom (<i>gathanpurna parmanu</i>). Many distinct, eternal <i>jeevan</i> exist.	Jivatman / Atman: Individuality (<i>jivatman</i>) is a <i>vyavahara</i> superimposition (VC, v. 244). The true Self (<i>Atman</i>) is identical to Brahman.	Self-Model (Physicalist): Evolved cognitive model. Experiential Monads (Panpsychism): Fundamental experience.	Cognitive Agent / Organism: Brain-generated process. Mind is what the brain <i>does</i> . No survival post-death.
Material Reality / Body	Jada Units / Shareer: Real, perpetual, transforming matter. Composes the body, which acts as the vehicle for <i>jeevan</i> .	Nama-Roop / Mithya: Form and name; robust at <i>vyavahara</i> ; sublated at <i>paramartha</i> .	Physical Matter: The primary concrete reality (Physicalism); or the outer aspect of experiential units (Panpsychism).	Matter & Energy: Consolidated excitations of quantum fields. Governed by conservation laws. Perpetual in base fields.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Relationships & Moral Order	Coexistence / Complementarity: Inherent, ontologically real values (<i>mulya</i>) and orderliness (<i>vyavastha</i>).	Ethics at <i>vyavahara</i>: Valid to purify the mind; <i>loka-sangraha</i> (BG); sublated at <i>paramartha</i> .	Social / Internal Relations: Relationality constitutes the self (Process); or evolutionary strategies for survival (Physicalism).	Ecology & Cooperation: Interdependent biological networks. Cooperation is an evolved behavioral strategy.
Primary Causation	Circular mutual causality (§§1.2–1.4): <i>Satta</i> as <i>mahakaran</i> ; dual activity triads; circular activity; <i>sanskar</i> -mediated human cycles.	Vivartavada: Apparent transformation on changeless Brahman (<i>satkaryavada</i> background).	Efficient / Creative Causation: Physical mechanisms (Physicalism); or “conrescence” (Process).	Physical Causation: Mathematical laws, conservation, entropy.
Ultimate Purpose / Realization	Awakening (<i>Jagriti</i>): Realization of coexistence, leading to resolved humane conduct (<i>manaviya aacharan</i>) in society.	Liberation (<i>Moksha</i>): Recognition of identity with Brahman; illusion of separate self dispelled (VC, v. 574).	Flourishing / Adaptation: Cognitive adaptability (Physicalism); aesthetic intensity of experience (Process).	Survival & Adaptation: Natural selection, entropy minimization (Friston 2010), homeostasis.

5.5 Is It Possible to Map Madhyasth Darshan to Advaita?

§5.5–5.6 develop the Advaita mapping in detail.

While the two systems arise from different core commitments (Advaita: non-dualism; Madhyasth Darshan: co-existentialism), several key entities in Advaita find close analogues or functional equivalents in Madhyasth Darshan:

1. Brahman corresponds to *Satta* (Omnipresence / Space)

- **Mapping:** Both are formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, timeless, and actionless. Both serve as the ontological ground of everything.

- **Divergence:** Advaita's Brahman is the *sole* absolute reality (*paramartha*), making the world an appearance (*mithya*). Madhyasth Darshan's *Satta* coexists with nature (*prakriti*); both are real. Brahman is awareness itself (*chit*), whereas *Satta* is actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*)—the condition of intelligibility—while active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs exclusively to the *jeevan* unit (§1.7).

2. Paramatman / Atman corresponds to Atma (in Jeevan) / Jeevan

- **Mapping:** Both point to the true, immortal, non-material reality of the self. Within the five-fold structure of *jeevan*, the *Atma* represents the innermost core of realization.
- **Divergence:** Advaita holds that the true Self (*Atman*) is exactly identical to the single, universal Supreme Self (*Paramatman*). Madhyasth Darshan denies a single universal self; it holds that *jeevan* units are permanently distinct, multiple, and active.

3. Jivatman (Jiva) corresponds to Deluded Jeevan (Bhramit Jeevan)

- **Mapping:** Both represent the individual embodied self experiencing the world, bound by ignorance (body-identification), and seeking liberation or resolution.
- **Divergence:** In Advaita, the *jivatman*–*Paramatman* duality is maintained only at *vyavahara* due to conditioning (*upadhis*); upon liberation, the duality is seen to have been false — what remains is Brahman alone (VC, v. 244). For Madhyasth Darshan, individuality is ontologically real and eternal; realization (*jagriti*) resolves delusion but preserves the active, distinct individuality of the *jeevan*.

4. Jagat / Nama-Roopa corresponds to Nature / Units (Prakriti / Ikai)

- **Mapping:** Both point to the physical universe of change, bodies, name, and form.
- **Divergence:** In Advaita, the Jagat is ultimately *mithya* (dependent appearance) and sublated at the highest realization. In Madhyasth Darshan, the world of units is *satat* (perpetual) and eternally real.

5. Pancha Kosha (Five Sheaths) corresponds to Five Functional Layers

- **Mapping:** Both map human structure through five layers: *annamaya* (food/body), *pranamaya* (vitality), *manomaya* (mind), *vijnanamaya* (wisdom/intellect), and *anandamaya* (bliss/realization).
- **Divergence:** In Advaita, the sheaths are eliminated through reasoning on Shruti passages (VC, vv. 210, 639), revealing the Self beneath — not primarily through *neti-neti* (which belongs to the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad). In Madhyasth Darshan, they are the **real functional equipment** of the human being (comprising body and *jeevan*) that are affirmed and harmonized in awakened living.

5.6 Unmappable Entities

Certain central entities and categories in Advaita Vedanta cannot be mapped to Madhyasth Darshan because they represent concepts that co-existentialism explicitly rejects:

1. Maya (as an Ontological Power of Projection/Concealment)

- Advaita's *Maya* is the cosmic power that conceals Brahman (*avarana*) and projects the illusion of the world (*vikshepa*). Madhyasth Darshan has no equivalent cosmic power or substance of illusion. Ignorance (*agnyan / bhrama*) is not a force or substance but merely the temporary cognitive absence of understanding (lack of awakening), which is resolved through study and education.

2. Adhyasa (Superimposition)

- In Advaita, the world is superimposed (*adhyasa*) on Brahman like a snake on a rope. Madhyasth Darshan has no concept of ontological superimposition. The relationship between units and *Satta* is **saturation (*samprikt*)**—a real, mutual, non-reductive co-location: units depend on *satta* for energy; *satta* depends on units for manifestation as activity (§1.2; SB, pp. 57, 62, 69)—not a projection or false attribution.

3. Mithya (Ontological Status of Dependent Appearance)

- Advaita introduces *mithya* (strictly *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing) to describe the world. Madhyasth Darshan rejects any intermediate ontological status: everything that exists is real, perpetual, and indestructible.

4. Ishvara (Saguna Brahman / Governor)

- In Advaita, Ishvara is Brahman associated with *Maya* — operative cause of name-form manifestation, a *vyavahara*-level category sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244), not a personal creator *ex nihilo*. Madhyasth Darshan rejects a personal creator deity who plans, acts, or dispenses grace. Orderliness (*vyavastha*) is self-regulation (*swatah-saspurt*) inherent in the natural laws of the co-existing orders, and *Satta* is entirely actionless (*kriya-shunya*).

5. Kaivalya / Recognition of identity (as Ultimate Liberation)

- Advaita seeks **recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman**, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled (*jiva-brahma-aikya* — unity/identity, not merger; VC, vv. 244, 574). Madhyasth Darshan holds that individual *jeevan* units remain eternally distinct; the ultimate goal is **awakened coexistence (*jagriti*)**, where *jeevan* units remain active in harmonious relationships (*sambandh*) with other humans and the ecological orders.

The mapping attempt reveals fundamental difficulties. While surface-level analogues exist, the core ontological commitments are ultimately irreconcilable. Advaita is a world-

subordinating non-dualism that views individuality and the universe as dependent appearances (*mithya*) to be transcended. In stark contrast, Madhyasth Darshan is a relational realism that affirms the eternal distinctness of sentient units and the perpetual reality of the world. Because of these profound differences, a true one-to-one mapping is impossible without distorting the foundational claims of either system.

5.7 Where the alliances fall

No single tradition wins every dispute. Three pairwise patterns clarify what each view shares with and denies to the others:

Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita against physicalism. Both refuse to treat existence as merely physicochemical matter. Consciousness, value, and the self are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena. Against reductive materialism, both hold that something more than bare mechanism is required — though they disagree sharply on what that “more” is.

Madhyasth Darshan and science against Advaita. Both treat the world as real and worth studying. Matter, bodies, relationships, and ecological order are not finally *mithya* or preparatory illusion. Against world-negating non-dualism, both insist that nature and society have final weight — though science does not affirm Omnipresence or immortal *jeevan*.

Advaita and science against Madhyasth Darshan. Both set a high bar for claims that exceed public evidence. Advaita holds that separate individuality was never ultimately real (VC, v. 574); science treats the self as a biological process that ceases at brain death. Against Madhyasth Darshan’s eternal distinct sentient units, both deny — on different grounds — that an immortal individual self is established.

Each pair agrees on something the third denies. Comparative clarity depends on naming which question is at stake: matter-only reduction, world-reality, or individual immortality.

6. Critical Review

6.1 Internal coherence of the Madhyasth Darshan position

Judged on its own definitions — not as proof against rivals — the ontology hangs together in several ways:

1. **It answers the three questions directly.** Existence is beingness and indestructibility as coexistence; what exists is Omnipresence and all units; what exists does not begin from non-being.
2. **It avoids world-negation.** “Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual” preserves the reality of nature, society, relationship, and ethical responsibility.
3. **It avoids simple material reductionism.** It refuses to treat consciousness, value, and selfhood as mere byproducts of body-chemistry.

4. **It links ontology and conduct.** If existence is coexistence, human fulfilment must be evidenced as coexistence in behavior, not merely believed.
5. **It is conservation-based.** “Nothing existent is annihilated” gives internal coherence to its account of body, *jeevan*, death, transformation, and development.

These are strengths **within** the system’s premises. They do not by themselves establish those premises against Advaita or physicalism (see §6.2–§6.6).

6.2 Open problems for Madhyasth Darshan

Internal coherence

1. **The emergence of sentience (§1.6).** Madhyasth Darshan holds that an insentient atom, through development, reaches constitutional completeness and becomes sentient *jeevan* (SB, pp. 55, 59). That account appears to require a quantitative threshold producing a qualitative change of kind — strong emergence. Yet the paper borrows Strawson’s anti-emergence principle against physicalism (§3.3). Three interpretive replies are available: (a) **latency** — sentience is eternally present through coexistence and actualized at completeness, not created from nothing (SB, p. 59); (b) **threshold-as-form** — what changes is achievement of a stable self-maintaining constitution, closer to weak emergence but uncomfortably near self-model theory (§4.1); (c) **bite-the-bullet** — accept strong emergence and qualify the Strawson borrowing. The latency reply is committed in §6.6; the physical mechanism of the Saturation-Reflector Model remains unspecified.
2. **Mutual dependence and the Nagarjuna challenge (§1.2).** Madhyasth Darshan holds that units depend on *satta* for energy and *satta* depends on units for manifestation as activity (§1.2). Nagarjuna’s critique of *svabhava* (intrinsic existence) asks whether such mutual dependence makes neither independently real — precisely the challenge Madhyasth Darshan must answer if coexistence is not to collapse into dependent co-arising without enduring units. The texts’ answer, implicit in the eternity of both *satta* and *ikai*, is that coexistence is beginningless: neither pole is ontologically posterior to the other. That reply needs explicit defense against Madhyamaka-style reduction.
3. **Satta–Ikai relation and circular causality.** §1.2–1.3 state mutual dependence and dual activity triads in prose; what remains is formalization — not discovery of whether the texts assert them.
4. **Mereology, identity, and conservation inference (§§1.5, 1.8).** Madhyasth Darshan reads *jeevan*’s indivisibility as functional (self-maintaining constitution) and identity as continuity of constitution across death and re-association (§1.5). What remains unsettled is whether functional indivisibility and constitution-identity over a gap of embodiment need fuller explicit criteria. JV p. 20 infers post-death survival from conservation. From the standpoint of modern science, this inference may commit a

category error by conflating **conservation of quantity** with **conservation of structure (or entity)**: physics conserves mass-energy and charge, but not specific configurations or functional identities. Thermodynamic conservation alone does not guarantee the immortality of a structured unit like *jeevan* unless *gathanpurnata* is already assumed as a separate metaphysical axiom. Furthermore, the claim of physical indivisibility for *jeevan* as a *parmanu* faces friction with particle physics, where no bound state is absolutely immune to decay or annihilation.

5. **Jeevan–body interaction.** If *jeevan* drives the body, the mechanism from intention to neural and muscular activity is unspecified.
6. **Provisioned structure vs deluded default (§1.5).** §1.5 states provisioned *drishti*, inherent orderliness (MVD, pp. 5, 14–15), and the gap between necessary humane refuge and deluded lower refuge (MVD, p. 67). What remains is fuller treatment at the intersection of ontology and conduct — especially how subordination of *priya–hita–labh* under *nyaya–dharma–satya* becomes lived reorganization rather than abandonment ([Ethics-And-Morals-In-Human-Beings](#) §3.2).

Evidence and science

1. **Constitutional completeness is not operational.** Central to the ontology but not presently measurable in physics or chemistry.
2. **Evidence standard vs. science.** Realization and behavior are cited; science requires public testability. What would count as evidence for *jeevan* beyond the hard-problem explanatory gap? §6.4 addresses this.

Comparative (deferred)

1. **“Knowledge but not knower” (§1.7).** Madhyasth Darshan calls Omnipresence *gyan* while denying it the activity of knowing; active *gyan udghatan* belongs only to awakened *jeevan* (§1.7). Comparative work must not collapse Omnipresence-as-*gyan* into Advaita’s *chit* (Brahman as awareness itself) — a misreading the English translation’s “Consciousness” label encourages (Editorial Notes). The full epistemic account belongs in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#).
2. **The nature of time (§1.8).** This paper states Madhyasth Darshan’s core claim — *kaal* as duration of activity, not independent substance; timeless *satta*; numerical reckoning within existence. Past/present/future structure, JVD on “activity eternally present,” and comparison with Advaita *trikaal* language, McTaggart, eternalism/presentism, and spacetime physics are developed in [Nature-Of-Time](#); residual open problems remain in that study’s §6.

6.3 Strengths and Limits of Advaita

Advaita has a powerful answer to non-being (existence cannot arise from non-existence, CU 6.2.2) and a rigorous first-person method — DDV’s seer-seen discrimination and MU’s three-state analysis (§2.2, §2.4). Its limit, from the Madhyasth perspective, is that making the world *mithya* at *paramartha* makes it harder to ground the **final** ontological weight of relationships, nature, society, and conduct — even though *vyavahara* is robust, shared, and law-governed (§2.3).

Advaita’s fair reply is substantial and should not be dismissed in a sentence. At *vyavahara*, ethics and compassion remain fully valid; realization of non-duality deepens rather than weakens them. Shankara’s *Vivekachudamani* insists on ethical discipline as prerequisite to knowledge (VC, vv. 17–19). The Bhagavad Gita, in Shankara’s commentary, grounds social responsibility in *loka-sangraha* — holding the world together — and ordained duty (*niyatam kuru karma*, BG 3.8): the enlightened still act for the welfare of the world. Advaita can therefore reply to the charge that *mithya* makes ethics untenable: ethics is binding at the level where life is actually lived.

The Madhyasth counter-reply is narrower but precise: an ontology that makes the world *mithya* at *paramartha* cannot give the world the **same final weight** coexistence gives it — relationships and nature are ultimately sublated, not perpetual. This is a genuine disagreement about final ontological status, not a defeat of Advaita on its own terms. The three-tier framework (§2.3) shows Advaita’s *mithya* is not sheer unreality like a hallucination (*pratibhasika*); the dispute is over whether *vyavahara*’s robustness suffices for Madhyasth Darshan’s standard of final world-realness.

6.4 Strengths and Limits of Modern Approaches

Modern approaches are strongest where Madhyasth Darshan is weakest: public evidence, empirical correction, cognitive modelling, precise mechanism. Self-model theory explains many features of embodied selfhood without an eternal *jeevan*; illusionism shows how a naturalist can reinterpret even the apparent obviousness of experience.

But modern philosophy is not unified. Chalmers and Nagel show experience resists reduction; Strawson shows some physicalists move toward panpsychism. It is inaccurate to say “modern philosophy has proved the self is only the brain.” What modern philosophy **has** established is a high evidential bar: an explanatory gap is not an existence proof for *jeevan*.

What would count as evidence? Public science would require at minimum: (a) operational criteria for constitutional completeness independent of the philosophy; (b) reproducible markers distinguishing *jeevan*-mediated from brain-only activity; (c) independent evidence for post-death continuity of a sentient unit. Until then, Madhyasth Darshan’s claims about immortal *jeevan* remain metaphysical assertions compatible with conservation principles but not validated by current science — while the hard problem shows physicalism’s own exposed point (§3.2).

6.5 Epistemology: partially incommensurable criteria

The three systems do not merely give different answers; they use different criteria for what counts as knowing:

Tradition	Method	Adequate for
Madhyasth Darshan	Study, realization, behavior, experiment	Coexistence as lived evidence; conduct as proof of understanding
Advaita	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination (DDV, VC)	Self as Brahman; sublation of <i>mithya</i>
Physicalism	Observation, modelling, public evidence	Mechanism, prediction, third-person confirmation

To that extent they are **partially incommensurable** — no single neutral tribunal settles them. What this paper attempts is narrower: test each for internal consistency, fit with public knowledge, and responsible distinction of posits from bare assertion. The epistemic standards of realization as proof are examined in [Knowledge, Knower, and Known](#).

6.6 Committed interpretation: latency and the Saturation-Reflector Model

If Madhyasth Darshan is to borrow Strawson’s anti-emergence principle against physicalism, it owes an explicit reply to the emergence tension (§6.2 item 1). This paper commits to the **latency reply** as the only internally consistent option, refined through the **Saturation-Reflector Model** (constitutional completeness stated in §1.6; canonical exposition here):

1. **Textual basis.** SB p. 59: all atom types, including constitutionally complete ones, are “eternally present through the natural law of coexistence.” Sentience is not created at completeness; it is actualized.
2. **Quantitative-stability support.** SB p. 55: at completeness, particle count is fixed; change is qualitative without quantitative addition — not the arrival of a new experiential ingredient from non-experience.
3. **Where potential resides.** Rather than locating latency in an abstract “law of coexistence,” the Saturation-Reflector Model holds that the potential for sentience is eternally present in the all-pervasive ground of *satta* (which is defined as *gyan*, the ground of all knowledge/consciousness). Insentient (*gathan-shil*) atoms lack the stable configuration required to express/reflect this ground. Once an atom achieves constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata*), its stable configuration acts as a “reflector,” allowing the ever-present *gyan* of *satta* to manifest as active sentience (*chaitanya*). This resolves the Strawson anti-emergence challenge by showing that experience is never generated from dead matter, but is mediated by structured matter from an ever-present conscious ground.

4. **What remains open.** This model is still a metaphysical framework, not a detailed physical mechanism. It keeps the system consistent with Strawson but does not answer physicalism's demand for third-person public evidence (§6.4), nor does it reconcile the physical indivisibility of the *parmanu* with modern particle physics.

Formalizing latency within the law of coexistence — and defending it against Nagarjuna's *svabhava* critique (§6.2) — is the most promising route for later rigorous work.

7. Conclusion

Madhyasth Darshan answers the paper's three questions through a single ontological picture.

Existence (*astitva*) is eternally present **coexistence** (*saha-astitva*): formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless sentient and insentient **units** (*ikai*) inseparably present together — neither made from the other, neither finally cancelled. **What exists** is that whole: the all-pervasive, actionless ground in which every unit is saturated (*samprikt*), energised, and regulated, together with the units themselves in their real form, properties, *dharma*, complementarity, and orderliness across the four ontological orders. **What exists does not begin** from non-existence (*abhava*): coexistence is beginningless; *satta* does not transform; units are not annihilated, though bodies, configurations, and associations do begin and end. Time (*kaal*) is the duration of unit-activity, not an independent cosmic container (§1.8).

Within this frame, **causation** is circular and order-specific, not creation from nothing. Omnipresence is *mahakaran* — the sustaining ground — not the efficient cause of particular change; the work of transformation belongs to units. Insentient nature moves through effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*); the sentient self (*jeevan*) through effort–motion–resolution (*shram–gati–pratishtha*). Sentience is the status of a constitutionally complete atom (*gathanpurna parmanu*), eternally present in coexistence and actualised at completeness rather than produced from dead matter (§§1.3–1.6, §6.6). Saturation in Omnipresence orients every unit toward **completeness** (§1.2): Development Progression in the atom reaches *gathanpurnata*; Awakening Progression in *jeevan* activates provisioned *drishti* toward activity and conduct completeness (§1.5). Nature develops through real plateaus — material, bio, animal, and knowledge orders — each with its own *dharma*. In the human order, **awakening** (*jagriti*) is completeness-driven activation of perspectives provisioned in *jeevan*'s design — lower *drishti* active by default, higher *drishti* coming online through *sanskar*, study, environment, and realization — until knowledge unfolds through the active *jeevan* and becomes evident as resolved humane conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) in relationship with other humans and the ecological orders.

“Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual.”

- MVD, p. 13

That formulation marks what is distinctive in comparative terms. Against **physicalism**, Madhyasth Darshan refuses matter-only reduction: consciousness, value, selfhood, and ethical relation are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena, yet the world of units remains fully real for study and responsibility — not a second-class appearance. Against **Advaita**, it refuses world-negation at the highest level: the perpetual world (*jagat satat*), distinct immortal *jeevan* units, and ontologically real relationships and values (*mulya*) retain final weight; coexistence is not compressed into a single subject whose empirical multiplicity is finally *mithya*. Against both, it holds a **relational realism**: Brahma is real, the world is real, and their inseparable presentness is coexistence — with ontology tied to conduct, so that understanding is fulfilled when coexistence becomes clear in one’s own seeing and evident in humane living, responsible work, and experiment. The pairwise patterns in §5.7 show where each tradition agrees and diverges on these stakes; the critical review in §6 examines what remains open within and against that position.

Editorial Notes

Translation and editorial conventions (*satta*)

The source texts’ primary English term for the all-pervasive, formless reality (*satta*) is **Omnipotence**; *vyapak* (“all-pervasive”) is rendered “Omnipresence” in the English translation. The English translation alternates **Omnipotence** and **Omnipresence** for the same *satta*; Hindi *satta* is the constant behind both. To avoid the theistic connotations of “Omnipotence,” this paper uses “**Omnipresence**” as its running English term in analytical prose. Block quotes preserve whichever word the translation prints. Where Hindi *shunya* appears, the translation renders it **Space** — void/emptiness (actionless, formless), not physical *akasha*.

“Consciousness” in SB p. 48

The English translation lists several names for the pervasive reality (*Satta / Vyapak*): Uniform Energy, Space (*akasha*), Knowledge (*gyan*), Consciousness, Omnipresence, Eternity, God, and Absolute Energy. In SB p. 48, the parenthetical “(consciousness)” labels the all-pervasive reality, not a personal knowing mind. Sentience as the activity of a knower (*chaitanya*) is the status of *jeevan* (the sentient unit), not of Omnipresence (*satta*) itself. This distinction is essential; the comparative risk of collapsing *satta-as-gyan* into Advaita’s *chit* is addressed in §6.2 item 9.

Naming tensions for *satta*

The source gives *satta* multiple English names. Several generate internal tensions if treated as interchangeable:

Name	Tension
Knowledge / Consciousness	Implies cognition — yet <i>satta</i> is denied as knower (§1.7).
Space / <i>Shunya</i>	Void/emptiness vs. fullness of energy; <i>shunya</i> is rendered “Space” in the English translation, not physical <i>akasha</i> .
God	Personhood vs. actionless, non-willing <i>satta</i> .
Absolute Energy	Dynamism vs. <i>kriya-shunya</i> (actionless).
Uniform Energy, Eternity	Listed alongside the names above; no single English label captures all aspects.

The source does not fully settle how these names cohere as one reality.

Advaita: *mithya* and *sad-asad-anirvacaniya*

The *mithya* doctrine and Advaita’s three-tier framework (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*) are related but distinct tools; §2 keeps them apart. The compound *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* is a post-Shankara systematic term (Vimuktatman, Vivarana school); Shankara uses “neither sat nor asat” language without that compound.

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- **CU** — *Chandogya Upanishad*. Cited: Existence alone, one without a second (6.2.1–6.2.2), with Shankara's commentary.
- **MU** — *Mandukya Upanishad*. Cited: three states of consciousness (*avastha-traya*), vv. 3–7 (§2.2).
- **BG** — *Bhagavad Gita*, Shankara's commentary (Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: *loka-sangraha* and ordained duty (3.8) (§6.3).
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